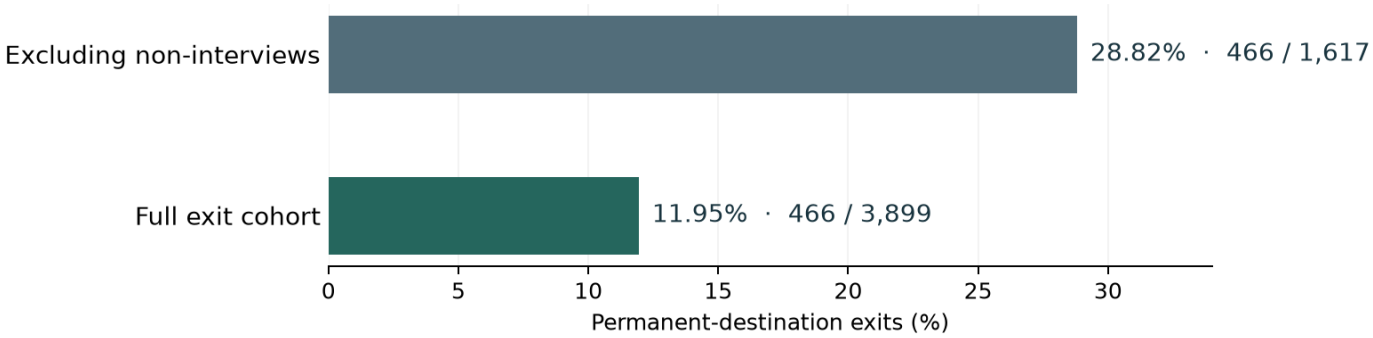
What Homelessness Outcome Numbers Actually Measure

For analysts, auditors and oversight committees
David L. Condrey · Independent; self-funded · October 18, 2026
SDHA-2026-01-B · Version 1.0 · Based on SDHA-2026-01 v1.3

Individual and combined APRs for the matched period show different active-client totals. Saved selections also differ; their causal contribution is not isolated. The historical example below separately tests the denominator effect. [NR57670541] [DR05]



Text equivalent: 466 / 1,617 = 28.82%; 466 / 3,899 = 11.95%.

This July 2022–January 2024 outreach example removes 2,282 no-interview records without creating any additional housing outcome; it is not a current City shelter rate. [ADC03]

> **Principal request:** Adopt one outcome-publication standard requiring the population, period, counting unit, report filters and missing-data treatment beside every published rate or comparison.

Responsible official: The HSSD Director should implement the standard with program data owners; auditors and oversight committees should use it when evaluating results.

> **Limit:** The calculation identifies a denominator effect without establishing why records lack interviews; reported destinations remain distinct from verified admissions and maintained housing.

Agency key: HSSD: City Homelessness Strategies and Solutions Department; APR: Annual Performance Report; HMIS: Homeless Management Information System.

Individual Safe Sleeping report [NR57670541] · original p. 1; period, filter and project IDs 1221/1514
Combined City performance report [DR05] · original p. 1; same six Q4 project IDs and filter
HSSD outreach performance report [ADC03] · original p. 1 project roster; pp. 28–30 outcome tables

Full-report pp. 8, 11, 70. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

The same project set produces two active-client totals.

Individual and combined Safe Sleeping Annual Performance Reports (APRs) cover the same six projects and July 2024–June 2025 period, yet their active-client totals differ.

Site and operator	Individual APR	Combined APR
20th & B / DfC	483	331
O Lot / DfC	867	580
O Lot / DSDP	566	386
Six-project sum	1,916	1,297

The difference is **619 project-person records, or 32.31%**, not 619 identified unique people. Individual headers show Enrollment CoC Filter: No, while the combined header shows Yes. [NR57670541] [NR57670542] [NR57670544] [DR05]

Bitfocus's documentation confirms that the filter narrows household selection at project entry, but different generation dates also permit later entries and corrections; the filter cannot be assigned the entire difference. [BITFOCUS-APR-PARAMETERS]

> **Apply the standard:** Publish saved parameters, project identifiers, generation dates and revision explanations with each report, and label sums across projects as such.

Separate input-version example: CDBG construction forms.

In CDBG construction monitoring, the City replaced faulty income-verification forms in November 2022, one day before its deadline; it replaced an incorrect questionnaire in January 2023. In March 2023 it acknowledged receipt of photos and spreadsheets with review still pending. These dated corrections establish input rework, not a quantified cost, delay or shelter-outcome distortion. [NR24157936] [NR24158003]

Individual Safe Sleeping report [NR57670541] · original p. 1; period, filter and project IDs 1221/1514
Individual DfC Safe Sleeping report [NR57670542] · original p. 1; IDs 1259/1260
Individual DSDP Safe Sleeping report [NR57670544] · original p. 1; IDs 1258/1477
Combined City performance report [DR05] · original p. 1; same six Q4 project IDs and filter
Bitfocus report-filter documentation [BITFOCUS-APR-PARAMETERS] · Enrollment CoC Filter parameter and household/project-entry selection
City monitoring-form correspondence [NR24157936] · original pp. 1, 8–9; City replacements and original deadline
City verification correspondence [NR24158003] · original pp. 2–3; March 22 City receipt acknowledgment

Full-report pp. 11, 53. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

State series: outreach rose; permanent-housing results fell.



RTFH reports successful street-outreach exits rising from **24% to 37% to 53%** across federal FY2023–FY2025; the definition includes specified temporary and institutional destinations as well as permanent housing. [DR07]

The state's CA-601 calendar-year series reports different developments for different measures:

Measure	CY2024	CY2025
Permanent-housing results, including qualifying move-ins / M3	6,711	6,027
Successful outreach placements / M6	5,324	6,014
Recorded six-month return / M5	9.4%	8.1%

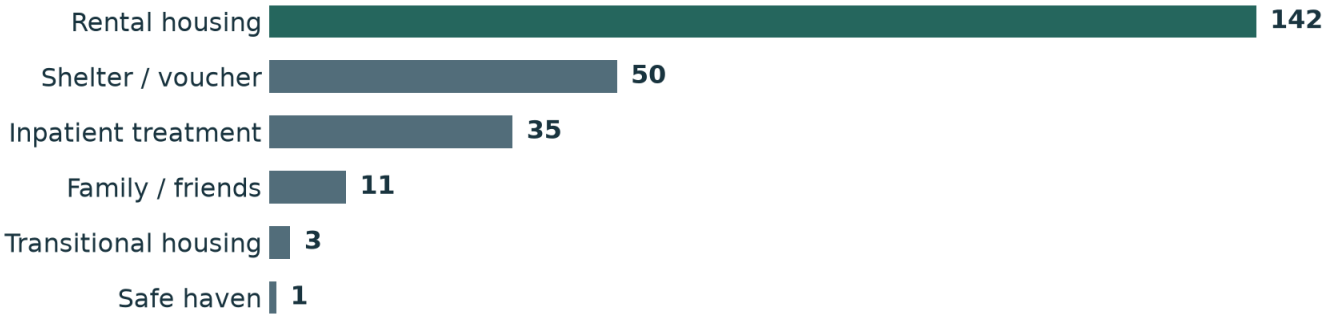
These measures concern different populations and stages; neither the outreach figure nor the absence of a recorded return establishes independently verified housing retention. [DR15] [DR17]

> **Interpretation:** The improving outreach measure and declining permanent-housing result can both be true; shared HMIS inputs do not make these publications independent person-level corroboration.

RTFH system performance report [DR07] · original pp. 3–5, 15; federal fiscal years October–September
State system-performance tables [DR15] · Location = CA-601 San Diego City & County CoC; M3–M6; CY2024 and CY2025 columns
State performance-measure guide [DR17] · original pp. 12–13, 18; M5 and exact CY2025 exit cohort

Full-report pp. 9, 10. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

The provider’s positive-exit total combines different destinations.



Dreams for Change’s public 2025 annual report lists **242 positive exits**, comprising 142 rental-housing exits, 50 shelter or voucher exits, 35 inpatient-treatment exits, 11 family/friends exits, three transitional-housing exits and one safe-haven exit. [DFC-2025-REPORT]

Category test. The sum reproduces, but its categories do not establish 242 permanent-housing placements; the publication gives no exact reporting window, project crosswalk or retention cohort.

Likewise, the UC San Diego study’s **31% permanent-destination share** concerns known most-recent destinations in a historical regional population, excluding about 30% with missing destinations; a separately reported 21% annual measure uses a different period and missing-data treatment. [UCSD26S] [UCSD26S]

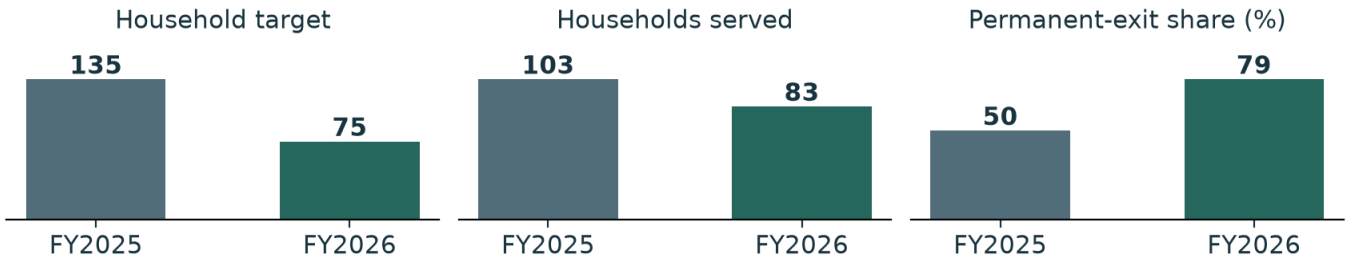
Endpoint	Evidence needed
Reported destination	What was recorded or planned at departure.
Verified admission	Confirmation from the receiving program or another authorized source.
Maintained housing	Verified status at the declared follow-up date, with losses and unknowns retained.

> **Apply the standard:** Preserve the provider’s original label, then state which endpoint its evidence actually supports.

Dreams for Change annual report [DFC-2025-REPORT] · original pp. 1, 8; title, destination table and stated broader success measure
UC San Diego shelter study [UCSD26S] · original pp. 1, 20–21 / printed pp. 17–18; Figure 15
UC San Diego shelter study [UCSD26S] · original pp. 6–7, 25 / printed pp. 3–4, 22

Full-report pp. 7, 16, 70. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

A lower target, a better exit share and separate unknowns.



From FY2025 to FY2026 at the same Alpha Project family shelter, the household goal fell from **135 to 75**, while households served fell **103 to 83**. The permanent-exit share improved from **50% to 79%**. FY2026 exceeded its lower household goal; the supplied releases do not provide the complete exiting-household counts needed to reconstruct the percentages. [CITY-FY25-CAPER] [CITY-FY26-CAPER]

A separate snapshot still has unknown destinations.



The July–August 2026 shelter dashboard reports **304 exiting households**, including **103 Not Reported (33.9%)**. Permanent destinations are 26.3% of all 304 but 39.8% of the 201 with a reported destination. [SDHC-SHELTER-DASHBOARD-2026-08] [SDHC-DASHBOARD-WELCOME-2026-08]

> **Separate cohorts:** The dashboard deduplicates households to their last shelter enrollment. It is not the annual family-shelter cohort or a unique-person union across all City programs. Unknown destinations remain in the full exit cohort.

> **Apply the standard:** Publish the target and its revisions, actual counts, exact exit cohort and unknown outcomes beside the result.

City annual performance report [CITY-FY25-CAPER] · original pp. 23–24; family shelter, targets, results and barriers
City annual performance report [CITY-FY26-CAPER] · original p. 19; family shelter annual results and contracted household goal
SDHC shelter outcome dashboard [SDHC-SHELTER-DASHBOARD-2026-08] · original static Shelter dashboard image; FY2027 through August 31, 2026; destination chart and deduplication footnote
SDHC dashboard date and scope [SDHC-DASHBOARD-WELCOME-2026-08] · original Welcome dashboard image; data current August 31, 2026

Full-report pp. 12. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

The published result is below the written annual target.

The executed July 2023 Family Reunification amendment requires good-faith efforts toward at least **700 unduplicated individuals** reconnected each July–June fiscal year. The provider's July 2024 board packet reports **513 for FY2024**: a published result **187 below target, or 26.7%**. [NR35389136] [DSDP-FY24]

Record	Reproduced comparison
Executed agreement	At least 700 unduplicated individuals; later option-year targets depend on funding.
Provider board packet	447 individuals through the earlier period plus June's 66 reproduces the 513 annual total.
City public account	A September 2024 article describes just over 500 people placed into housing in FY2024. That narrative does not replace the contract's reporting unit or certify retention.

The City account describes housing placements, while the contract specifies reconnected individuals. Retain both labels: the numerical target comparison does not verify arrival or housing retention. [CITY-FRP-FY24]

Scope: This is not a certified unduplicated HMIS reconciliation or a City breach determination. The released records do not establish an accepted cohort report or an applicable revised target. The agreement allows a performance improvement plan to be required; the arithmetic alone does not determine enforcement.

Decision consequence: Publish the operative target, any authorized revision, actual result and counting method together. A percentage or narrative success claim should not displace the underlying contractual measure.

This is Family Reunification evidence. It does not measure Safe Sleeping performance or establish long-term housing retention.

Executed Family Reunification amendment [NR35389136] · original pp. 3, 5, 14–15, 37; signatures, target and performance terms
Provider annual reporting packet [DSDP-FY24] · original pp. 6, 11; individuals, households and July–June total
City Family Reunification account [CITY-FRP-FY24] · September 13, 2024; final two substantive paragraphs

Full-report pp. 17. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Attach the population and exclusions to every published result.

Requested direction: HSSD and data owners apply this disclosure panel to the next published rate/comparison, retaining original measures and stating comparability.

Disclosure field	Filled example: SDHC intake summary
Population / unit	CSIP referral events; duplicative. A person may have incomplete referrals and later a completed referral.
Period / source version	July 1–August 31, 2026; August 31 update. The preserved original identifies this edition of the mutable publisher file.
Numerator / denominator	468 complete / 4,828 total; 4,360 incomplete retained in the total.
Published / reproduced rate	10% published, 9.69% reproduced: valid whole-percent rounding.
Comparability / limit	Does not measure unique-person denial, verified retention or a trend against the earlier unique-seeker calculation.

Owner decision: Mark comparisons comparable, qualified or not comparable, with reasons. APRs retain project roster, saved filters, generation date, exclusions and maturity. Preserve favorable results and original labels. Reviewers reproduce totals from authorized inputs; public outputs use safe aggregates, not identifiers.

Proposed specifications: `Measurement-Specification.json` and `Proposed-Data-Dictionary.csv`. No adopted City standard or new causal evaluation is claimed. Original contributions: CC BY 4.0. Counts/rounding reproduce. [SDHC-CSIP-2026-08]

External evaluation: RTFH's 2024 program evaluation separates outreach (**1,495 people / 1,270 households; 5%** reported permanent exits) from flexible assistance (**597 people / 489 households; 93%**). Its **96% at 12 months** stability headline states no follow-up denominator or reached/unknown counts. Promising reported results; distinct groups are not a causal comparison, and retention cannot be independently reproduced. [HF-RTFH-DIVERSION]

SDHC August 2026 intake summary [SDHC-CSIP-2026-08] · original p. 1; August 31, 2026 update; July–August referral tables, reasons and occupancy footnotes
RTFH · 2024 diversion evaluation, revised August 2025 [HF-RTFH-DIVERSION] · original pp. 1, 4–5, 8; service groups, rates and monitoring

Full-report pp. 6, 8, 11, 63, 70, 81, 82. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Match the result to the signed term and target.

A year-round narrative conflicts with the contract.

350-bed Paul Mirabile Center: FY2025 reporting narrative versus signed operating term.

Record	July–December 2024	January–June 2025
CAPER / ESG return	All-year operation →	→ All-year operation
Signed FY2025 option	**July 1–December 31, 2024**	Outside this signed term
IBA closure account	**Closed December 2024**	February IBA confirms closure

The separate 350-person served count is not disproved: the six-month scope itself requires at least 350 people, including triage clients. [CITY-FY25-CAPER] [NR53645063-M06] [EXP-IBA25-06-MIDYEAR]

High occupancy can coexist with fewer admissions.

Connections reports **153 people against a signed 175-person minimum** in FY2026, with **98% occupancy** and **40% of exiting clients going to permanent housing**. The City attributes lower throughput to higher needs and longer stays. The contract's permanent-destination target is 26%. [CITY-FY26-CAPER] [NR53645063-M32]

The regional goal was missed in its target year.

The final HHAP3 unsheltered goal for 2024 was **3,852**; the state series records **6,110**, or **2,258 above target**. The 2025 count later declined to 5,714. This is a regional count, not a City-only outcome or a finding of grant misuse. [EXP-HHAP3-FINAL-GOALS] [DR15]

> **Requested update:** Correct the service-period narrative, report the matched contract review and distinguish throughput, occupancy, exit shares and regional targets.

City annual performance report [CITY-FY25-CAPER] · original p. 24; all-year narrative
Signed PMC option agreement [NR53645063-M06] · original pp. 1–2, 4–5; six-month term and service minimum
IBA FY2025 midyear review [EXP-IBA25-06-MIDYEAR] · original p. 15; December closure
City annual performance report [CITY-FY26-CAPER] · original p. 19; results and higher-needs explanation
Signed Connections option agreement [NR53645063-M32] · original pp. 1, 4–5, 8; signed option and outcome table
Final regional HHAP3 goal table [EXP-HHAP3-FINAL-GOALS] · original p. 2; final regional target
State system-performance tables [DR15] · Location=CA-601 San Diego City & County CoC; Metric=M1b; 2020/2024/2025 columns

Full-report pp. 10, 62, 63. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.